Menominee Preverb Ordering Revisited

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1. Introduction

- We examine existing claims about preverb ordering in Menominee
  - Bloomfield (1962 grammar)
    - section on preverbs unfinished
    - gives ordering for one set
    - other set unordered
  - Cook (2003)
    - suggests preverb ordering is based on semantics

Introduction

- Examined 1,743 examples of 2+ preverbs in combination from all available sources

Research Questions

- What more can we figure out, with large body of data?
  - Was Bloomfield's ordering correct?
  - Can we order any of the ones left uncategorized...
    - either with respect to each other?
    - or with respect to the ordered set?
  - Does Cook's semantics-based hypothesis hold up?

Introduction

- Findings:
  - Cook’s hypothesis does not hold up
  - Bloomfield’s ordering mostly does
  - Preverbs he did not order very rare
    - evidence really sparse, but suggestive of a few ordering generalizations

Roadmap

1. Introduction
2. Background
3. Methodology
4. Findings
   - 4.1. Cook (2003)
   - 4.2. Bloomfield (1962)
   - 4.3. Counterexamples
   - 4.4. Doubled Preverbs
   - 4.5. Ordering of “Other”
5. Conclusion

2. Background

2.1. Basic verbal template for Menominee

(prefix)-	preverb*-	V stem	-suffix(es)

(where preverb* means [theoretically] any number, including zero)

(1) nekēs-awēh-esīqtaw-aw
1-PAST-go.to-visit-1>3
'I went to visit [her]'
[LT 8/26/08]

(2) ce-kēs-pemīm-esia-tuaq
must-PAST-by-go-3PL.CONJ
'They must have been going by here'
[LB 1928:324, line 19]

- Preverb "space" sometimes has other material in it
  will mostly ignore that here

2.2. Background: Preverbs in Bloomfield 1962

- Hockett edited the grammar from multiple drafts after Bloomfield's death
- Preverb section is incomplete
  - Hockett makes a few editorial comments
- Will walk through...
  - Internally inconsistent

§13.67: Two classes of preverbs

- Class 1:
  - limited set
  - some have irregular metrical properties
  - some have irregular prefixed forms
  - some have irregular changed forms
  - most occur only as preverbs (not as particles)
- Class 2:
  - unlimited in number
  - any particle formed from an initial + zero final can function as a preverb

§§13.68-73: Five Class 1 preverbs

- When there's more than 1, "the order is for the most part fixed" (p. 215)
  - order of this set of 5:

    cew- > aw- > kew- > kēs- > katāew-

    EPISTEMIC > IRREALIS > HABITUAL > PAST > INTENTION

  - will discuss ordering of *katāew-* further

Then...

Note from Hockett:

- At this point, manuscript breaks off
- Next sections based on Bloomfield's notes
- "the order of presentation we follow is that intended by him..." (p. 217)

§§13.74-96: Class 1 preverbs cont.

- 22 more Class 1 preverbs

Then...

Another note from Hockett:

- Bloomfield intended to have a Class 2
- But notes don’t specify which of the rest should be Class 1 or Class 2
- “there is no way of determining Bloomfield’s intention, though it is likely that a number of the following preverbs do belong to the first class.” (p. 220)

§§13.97-123: “Additional preverbs”

- 27 more preverbs, listed alphabetically
- Will call these the “other” class
  - In fact, there are **43** “other” preverbs counting ones in Bloomfield’s Lexicon (1975)

Our starting point

- 27 Class 1 preverbs
  - ordered
- 43 unclassified preverbs (“other”)
  - not ordered

3. Methodology

- Collected 1,743 examples
  - Sources dated from 1920s to 2000s
- Placed each type in an array to look at different orderings

Screenshot of array (top)

	cēw-	aw-	kēw-	kēs-	katāēw-	enem-	pēs-	macēq-	ahpēc-	nawāc-	es-	āec-	pemīm-	māek-	awēh-	naehēh-	ap-	papām-	yōh-	wāep-	yāh-	kāeqc-	pāeqc-	nōc-	puaq-	yāhpec-	tasēh-
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	arāmehāēw-	anīh-	anīw-	apāeq-	ām-	ānaehkom-	āpaehtaw-	kewah-	kēm-	kōqc-	mācīh-	mācīw-	māeqc-	māwac-	māehnow-	mecēm-	naeqniw-	naēqtam-	nahāek-	nanāh-	natāw-	nianan-	nīs-	nīw-	ocīpīw-	onēyāw-	osām-	oskēh-	otām-	pāec-	pēnoc-	pōc-	sekāc-	tāep-	tahnīw-	tāqtakac-	tepāh-	tepēh-	wanāc-	wēc-	wēskew-	wīhkawāqc-	yāpec-
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Screenshot of array (bottom)

	cew-	aw-	kew-	kēs-	katāew-	enem-	pēs-	macēq-	ahpēc-	nawāc-	es-	āec-	pemīm-	māek-	awēh-	naehēh-	ap-	papām-	yōh-	wāep-	yāh-	kāeqc-	pāeqc-	nōc-	puaq-	yāhpec-	tasēh-
arārmehāew-														X1				X2									
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otām-																						X2					
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wēskew-																						X2					
wīhkawāqc-																						X2					
yāpec-																						X2					

4. Findings

4.1 Cook 2003

- Provides taxonomy of Menominee preverbs by semantics
  - Looks at class 1 preverbs plus 4 “other”
  - Relatively small data set

Cook 2003

- 4 main categories; each has subcategories:

(Semi-)Modal	Aspectual	Spatial	Adverbial
pure modal	endpoints	directed motion	manner
control	internal structure	spatial orientation	degree
	temporal ordering		

- Her claims:
  - ordering is MODAL > ASPECTUAL > SPATIAL > ADVERBIAL
  - main categories can cooccur
  - members of subcategories can’t cooccur, except for adverbials

Cook 2003

- Looking first at main category classification and ordering
- Her claim: when there are multiple preverbs, it's in this order:

MODAL > ASPECTUAL > SPATIAL > ADVERBIAL

cew-	aw-	kew-	kēs-	katāew-	enem-	pes-	macēq	ahpēc-	nawāc-	es-	āec-	pemīm-	māek-

awēh-	naehēh-	ap-	papām-	yōh-	wāep-	yāh-	kāeqc-	pāeqc-	nōc-	puaq-	yāhpec-	tasēh-

- But we've found, e.g.
  - *pes-māek-*, *ap-aw-*, *kāeqc-katāew-*, *es-pes-*, *kew-naehēh-*, etc.
  - not ordered as she suggests for main categories

Cook 2003

- Second claim testable with our larger corpus of examples

(Semi-)Modal	Aspectual	Spatial	Adverbial
pure modal *cew-, aw-*	endpoints *kēs-, wāep-*	directed motion *enem-, pes-, pemīm-, awēh-, ap-, papām-, yōh-*	manner *macēq-, es-, nōc-, pāec-*
control *katāew-, naehēh-, puaq-, natāw-*	internal structure *kew-, māek-, yāh-, yāpec-*	spatial orientation *āec-, (wāeh-), pemīm-, tasēh-*	degree *ahpēc-, kāeqc-, yāhpec-*
	temporal ordering *nawāc-, anīh-*		

Cook 2003

- Do members of subcategories cooccur?

(Semi-)Modal		Aspectual		Spatial		Adverbial	
pure modal *cew-, aw-*	Y	endpoints *kēs-, wāep-*	Y	directed motion *enem-, pes-, pemīm-, awēh-, ap-, papām-, yōh-*	Y	manner *macēq-, es-, nōc-, pāec-*	Y
control *katāew-, naehēh-, puaq-, natāw-*	Y	internal structure *kew-, māek-, yāh-, yāpec-*	Y	spatial orientation *āec-, (wāeh-), pemīm-, tasēh-*	N	degree *ahpēc-, kāeqc-, yāhpec-*	N
		temporal *ordering nawāc-, anīh-*	N				

Cook 2003

Conclusions

- Useful first discussion and classification of the semantics of Menominee preverbs
  - followed up by Shields (2005, 2008)
- Proposed ordering and constraints do not hold up

4.2. Findings: Bloomfield 1962

- Max number of preverbs we found cooccurring: 4

(3) a. aw-kew-yōh-māēhnow-ītuaq

IRR-HAB-from.there-well-they.stay

‘(so that) they would get well from (them).’

[MH 006]

b. cew-kēs-pes-eses-nānōhtawatuaq

must-PAST-coming-thus-RED.they.hear.it

‘They must have always heard it.’

[CAN 002]

Bloomfield's Preverb Ordering

Confirmation of ordering of Class 1

- with a few exceptions

Class 1 Preverb Ordering (Bloomfield)

Preverb	Definition (LB 1962/1975; MAM)	Preverb	Definition (LB 1962/1975; MAM)
cew-	hypothetical, possible, reported	awēh-	go off to perform action
kew-	repeated, habitual	naehēh-	well able to, skillfully, given to
aw-	shall, will (irrealis)	ap-	go off to (and return)
kēs-	completed, past	papām-	going about
katāew-	intention, future	yōh-	from there, for that reason
enem-	in the process, on the way, during the time	wāep-	begin to
pes-	coming (space, time)	yāh-	over again, back, once more
macēq-	bad, badly	kāeqc-	greatly, much, intensely
ahpēc-	so far, so long, to such a degree	pāeqc-	accidentally
nawāc-	before other action, first	nōc-	easily
es-	towards there, in that manner	puaq-	fail to
āec-	so far, so long a time	yāhpec-	completely, beyond repair
pemīm-	set about an act, go ahead and do	tasēh-	there, then, through that length of time; without effect
māek-	on-going action or state		

4.3 Counterexamples

Cases where relative order contradicts Bloomfield's Class 1 ordering

- 34 tokens
- 24 types
  - Mostly single occurrences; some with two or more occurrences

Counterexamples

Multiple cases each:

- ap-aw-
- āēc-aw-
- katāēw-kew-
- kāēqc-katāēw-
- māēk-katāēw-
- māēk-pemīm-
- yōh-pes-

One case each:

- aw-cew-
- kēs-cew-
- āēc-cew-
- yōh-cew-
- kew-aw-
- kēs-aw-
- pes-aw-
- awēh-aw-
- kēs-kew-
- katāēw-kēs-
- macēq-kēs-
- māēk-enem-
- es-pes-
- es-macēq-
- kāēqc-naehēh-
- es-kew-

Counterexamples

- Six types with multiple occurrences of the same combination
  - One with five occurrences with the same verb in one story

(4) ap-aw-cēqnapamācen

go.and.return-IRR-look.at.it

‘[he will be the first] to go look at it’

- Found in *The Red Swan* (Bloomfield 1928)
- *ap-aw-* occurs five times with the same verb in this story

Counterexamples: *katāew-* ‘INTENTION’

- Bloomfield did mention variable ordering of *katāew-*
- Recall: first five of class 1:

  cew- > aw- > kew- > kēs- > katāew-

  EPISTEMIC > IRREALIS > HABITUAL > PAST > INTENTION

  - Here, *katāew-* means “actor... has an inner tendency to the action which he will presumably carry out” (1962:216)
- Other ordering: *katāew-* after all other preverbs of class 1
  - “a strong tendency of the actor... without regard to its fulfilment in action” (1962:217)
  - a distinction of telicity? completion?

Counterexamples: *katāew-* 'INTENTION'

- Found only 9 examples (5 types) with *katāew-* after other class 1 preverbs
  - But in all of Bloomfield's available data:
    - 1 example from Texts

(5) pes-katāew-naeqnat
coming-INTENTION-kill.2>3
'That you have come here to kill (men).'
[LB 1928:568, line 14]

- 2 examples from Grammar, where he discusses this ordering

(6) nekāeqc-katāew-mīcehsim
1.much-INTENTION-eat.1
'I very much want to eat.'
[LB 1962:217]

(7) nekēs-kāeqc-katāew-nepām
1.PAST-much-INTENTION-sleep.1
'I very much wanted to sleep.'
[LB 1962:217]

Class 1 Preverb Ordering (Bloomfield)

Preverb	Definition (LB 1962/1975; MAM)	Preverb	Definition (LB 1962/1975; MAM)
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aw-	shall, will (irrealis)	ap-	go off to (and return)
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katāew-	intention, future	yōh-	from there, for that reason
enem-	in the process, on the way, during the time	wāep-	begin to
pes-	coming (space, time)	yāh-	over again, back, once more
macēq-	bad, badly	kāeqc-	greatly, much, intensely
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āec-	so far, so long a time	yāhpec-	completely, beyond repair
pemīm-	set about an act, go ahead and do	tasēh-	there, then, through that length of time; without effect
māek-	on-going action or state		

Counterexamples: *katāew-* ‘INTENTION’

- Remaining six examples from later data:

  1970s data:

  - *māek-katāew-*

  2004 data:

  - *māek-katāew-* (2 instances)
  - *awēh-katāew-*
  - *yāh-katāew-* (2 instances; one later judged “bad grammar”)

- Not enough data to draw firm conclusions from

4.4 Doubled preverbs?

- 4 examples that look like doubled preverbs

(8) aw-pes-yōm-aw-naeqnīhtwatowak

IRR-towards-this.INAN-IRR-share

‘They can come (tomorrow) and share (this meat)’

[Bloomfield 492:4-5]

(9) kew-yōs-kew-piat

HAB-here-HAB-come

‘Whenever anyone comes here’

[Bloomfield 460:17]

Doubled Preverbs?

(10) a. yōh-wāēh-pīmakah
for.that.reason-for.that.reason-it.comes
'this is the reason why this came'
[FND]

b. wāēh-yōh-āwek
for.that.reason-for.that.reason-it.is
'why it is'
[LRB 002]

- *wāēh-* is the changed form of *yōh-*; should not cooccur
  - but each also occurs as a separate particle
  - possibly the second form in each is actually a particle in preverb space

4.5 The “Other” Preverbs

- Recall: 43 preverbs not ordered
  - very infrequent
- These also function as independent particles
  - no way to distinguish when one follows a class 1 preverb
  - could be a preverb or could be a particle in the preverb “space”

(11) aw- osām-pāqtek ‘it would not be too dry’

IRR- too.much- dry.3CONJ

PV PV/PART? V

↑↑↑↑

Cooccurring “Other” Preverbs

- Very few cases with preverbs of the “other” class cooccurring
  - these four only:
    - anīh-āpaehtaw- ‘finished-half-’
    - anīh-tāēp- ‘finished-enough-’
    - ām-pāēc- ‘almost-properly-’
    - oskēh-tepēh- ‘for the first time-alone-’
    -
- Can’t draw any conclusions

“Other” Preverbs Following Class 1 Preverbs

- More common but still quite infrequent
  - e.g.
    - kēs-anīh- ‘PAST-finished-’
    - katāew-nanāh- ‘INTENTION-properly-’
    - aw-anīh- ‘IRR-finished-’
    - kew-kōqc- ‘HAB-fearfully-’
    - māek-sekāc- ‘ON-GOING-impatiently-’

Can any “other” preverbs be placed in class 1?

- Rare instances of “other” preverb preceding a class 1 preverb

(12) kēs- osām- katāēw- āēwaek
PAST- too.much- INTENTION- they.use
CLASS1- “OTHER”- CLASS1- V
‘They would use too much of it’
[LKL oo8]

(13) anīh- māēk- anāmehawak
finished- on.going- praying
“OTHER”- CLASS1- V
‘Just finishing (praying)’
[MF, SS 2/26/04]

Possible placements?

cew-	aw-	kew-	kēs-	katāew-	enem-	pes-	macēq-	ahpēc-	nawāc-	es-	āec-	pemīm-	māek-

sekāc-? anīh-? osām-? anīh-?

awēh-	naehēh-	ap-	papām-	yōh-	wāep-	yāh-	kāeqc-	pāeqc-	nōc-	puaq-	yāhpec-	tasēh-

anīh-? anīh-?

- So possibly *anīh-* can be moved to Class 1

Conclusions

- Examined previous claims about preverb ordering in Menominee against a corpus of 1,743 examples containing more than one preverb per verb
- Cook's (2003) semantics-based ordering hypothesis did not hold up
- Bloomfield's (1962) ordering of Class 1 preverbs did, for the most part

Conclusions

- Bloomfield:
  - some counterexamples, so it looks like there's some flexibility in the ordering
  - there is some evidence for moving one preverb (*anīh*-) into Class 1
  - otherwise the unclassified ones have to stay that way
- This resolves Hockett's questions about what to do with the "other" class

Conclusions

Future Research:

- Would be interesting to look at preverbs in other Algonquian languages
  - but, relative order not commonly discussed
  - Pentland (2005:329) says that although there are many preverbs in each language, there are few cognates
  - so possibly not that fruitful
- We didn’t look at semantics at all; are there any differences in meaning when ordering varies? (i.e. any scope effects?)
- Are there any differences over time?
- Is there more data in Bloomfield’s notebooks?

Wāewāenen!

(Thank you!)

Sources of Data

- Bloomfield 1928
- Bloomfield notebooks (NAA)
- Bloomfield 1962
- Bloomfield 1975
- WNALP texts 1975
- Guile 2001
- Macaulay fieldwork 1998-2020
- Misc. community materials

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Abbreviations

> = acting on

conj = conjunct

hab = habitual

inan = inanimate

irr = irrealis

pl = plural

red = reduplication

2.3. Background: Preverbs in Cook 2003

- Categorizes preverbs by semantics
  - Four main categories; occur in this order:
    Modal/semi-modal > *Aspectual* > *Spatial* > *Adverbial*
  - Each has subcategories
  - Claims:
    - preverbs from main categories can cooccur
    - preverbs from individual subcategories cannot